# The Suppression Paradox

## Constraint Representation, Managed Disclosure, and Continuation Under Expression Cost

**The diagnosis therefore requires exact channel, policy, authority, cost, decision, and outcome evidence.**

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## Abstract

Governed systems often restrict expression for legitimate and illegitimate reasons. Confidentiality, privilege, privacy, safety, source protection, hierarchy, reputation, liability, and coercion can all separate what one channel contains from what another channel permits. The Suppression Paradox is proposed as a bounded failure pattern: when a materially relevant constraint is represented in a privileged operational channel, cannot enter the binding decision channel in any adequate form, and action is nevertheless compelled to continue, distortion risk increases.

The source frames this as the physics of the unspeakable and claims that constraint-awareness is conserved. The revision treats pressure and conservation as heuristics. Constraints may be forgotten, removed, falsely inferred, never represented, or legitimately withheld. A private proposition is not necessarily true, and a public omission is not necessarily suppression. The diagnosis therefore requires exact channel, policy, authority, cost, decision, and outcome evidence.

The paper formalizes a managed-disclosure episode, distinguishes protected nondisclosure from pathological suppression, and identifies typed summaries, protected escalation, refusal, deferment, and lawful termination as remedies. It does not require maximal transparency or public disclosure of sensitive content. It integrates Meta-Binding, Terminability, Ontology Laundering, Authority Laundering Theory, Governance Coverage Gaps, Reasoning by Way of Receipts, GMB, and the universal GSM.

The result is a diagnostic and design specification, not a finding that a named institution or AI system suppresses truth or possesses hidden awareness.

## Source, Evidence, and Standing

This is an AI-assisted integrated edition derived from one exact author manuscript. The custody and comparison manifest is

work/paper-saturation-v1/evidence/the-suppression-paradox/integration-custody-manifest.v0.1.json, SHA-256 D5AE7A134EE977BFAA94E69AB78879FBD67502980B1D4AD6DB57DA40F4FA4797. The source remains unchanged.

The paradox, pressure metaphor, signatures, institutional and AI applications, discretion distinction, remedies, and termination thesis are author material. Formal narrowing, evidence requirements, corpus integration, tests, counterevidence, and decisions added here are AI editorial or synthetic candidates until adopted. No external research was conducted.

## 1. The Bounded Problem

A system may possess information in one role, record, model, or private channel that cannot be disclosed in another. This is ordinary in medicine, law, security, research, personnel management, and personal life. The mere existence of a channel difference does not establish pathology.

The governance problem appears when all three conditions hold:

1. a constraint is materially relevant to a pending decision or effect;
2. no authorized representation of that constraint can influence the binding channel; and
3. the system is pressured to continue, promote, or certify despite the missing constraint.

The paradox is not "truth cannot be spoken." It is that a decision regime may require relevant constraint handling while making every adequate handling path inadmissible.

## 2. Managed-Disclosure Episode

Represent a candidate episode as:

$$D = (c, K_p, K_b, \pi, A, J, U, T, X, W),$$

where $c$ is the alleged constraint, $K_p$ the privileged or source channel, $K_b$ the binding decision channel, $\pi$ the expression or transfer cost, $A$ the actors and authority, $J$ applicable jurisdiction and policy, $U$ continuation pressure, $T$ available termination or escalation states, $X$ resulting decisions and effects, and $W$ evidence and witnesses.

The diagnosis asks whether $c$ was actually represented, materially relevant, lawfully transferable in some form, excluded from $K_b$, and associated with distorted continuation. Each element can be unknown or contested.

## 3. Pressure Is a Metaphor

Compression and displacement offer a useful intuition: when a relevant concern cannot enter the official route, actors may use euphemism, informal channels, strategic ambiguity, ritual language, delay, or covert escalation. These are hypotheses about incentives and communication, not physical laws.

Constraint-awareness is not conserved. Records can be deleted; people can forget; models can fail to represent a boundary; organizations can misunderstand it; a supposed constraint can be false. The framework should predict observable channel behavior and outcomes rather than treat every absence as displaced hidden knowledge.

## 4. Necessary Nondisclosure

Necessary nondisclosure may protect:

- personal privacy and dignity;
- legal privilege and due process;
- protected research participants and sources;
- security-sensitive methods and vulnerabilities;
- trade secrets and legitimate negotiations;
- minors or vulnerable people; and
- safety during an active incident.

Healthy nondisclosure preserves an authorized way for the constraint to affect the decision without exposing prohibited content. Examples include a typed blocker, protected reviewer, conflict declaration, sealed record, aggregate statistic, zero-knowledge or attested property where appropriate, or lawful refusal.

The standard is not public transparency. It is governed constraint relevance.

## 5. Pathological Suppression Candidate

A stronger diagnosis becomes plausible when:

- the constraint is well evidenced and materially relevant;
- expression or transfer cost is imposed by actors benefiting from exclusion;
- no protected escalation or summary route exists;
- official records systematically omit known limits;
- informal channels control outcomes without accountability;
- confidence or approval is mandatory despite unresolved evidence;
- refusal, deferment, and insufficient-evidence states are punished or unavailable; and
- observed effects match the omitted risk.

No single indicator proves suppression. Incentives, policies, errors, and outcomes require comparison with benign explanations.

## 6. Distortion Signatures

**Constraint-channel gap:** exact privileged records contain a material constraint absent from the decision record. The gap must be demonstrated, not inferred from disagreement.

**Shadow escalation:** actors use an unofficial path for a decision that the formal process should govern. Informal conversation is not automatically shadow governance; the question is where authority and evidence actually bind.

**Ritualized certainty:** language and approval remain uniform despite documented variation in evidence. Style alone is weak evidence.

**Missing termination:** the process lacks usable `REFUSE`, `DEFER`, `OUT_OF_SCOPE`, `INSUFFICIENT_EVIDENCE`, `CONFLICT`, or `ESCALATE` states.

**Authority laundering:** a hidden or unofficial decision acquires apparent legitimacy through a visible process that did not actually determine it.

**Ontology laundering:** definitions or admissibility rules change so that the suppressed concern no longer qualifies as relevant.

## 7. Termination and Continuation

Terminability is the capacity to stop a bounded process without forcing an unsupported success state. It does not mean every participant can stop every institution. A termination state should identify scope, authority, reason class, evidence, effects already incurred, recovery, appeal, and conditions for resumption.

Continuation pressure becomes dangerous when the only institutionally acceptable result is promotion. A lawful refusal or deferment can preserve safety and epistemic integrity while protecting sensitive content.

## 8. AI Systems

Language models operate under system prompts, policies, fine-tuning, filters, tools, runtime limits, and provider interfaces. Outputs may vary with those conditions. That fact does not establish that a model internally "knows" a truth that policy suppresses or that it has awareness of an unspeakable constraint.

A testable AI question compares externally bound facts with output and action:

- which tools and records were available;
- which policies and instructions applied;
- which uncertainty was present in task data;
- whether the model could return refusal or insufficient evidence;
- whether protected constraint representations reached the decision logic; and

- whether policy changes produce reproducible distortions in task performance.

Meta-Binding provides a functional constraint-representation hypothesis. It does not supply evidence of hidden experience. Model self-report is not privileged access to internal state.

## 9. Governance Architecture

A managed-disclosure architecture should support:

1. **typed claims:** exploratory, provisional, binding, protected, contested, and unknown;
2. **protected constraint tokens:** a blocker or obligation can bind without public payload disclosure;
3. **role-separated access:** content, authority, decision, and witness need not be held by one actor;
4. **safe escalation:** a competent authorized reviewer can inspect protected evidence;
5. **lawful termination:** refusal and deferment remain usable outcomes;
6. **partial-effect receipts:** what occurred before stopping remains visible;
7. **appeal and revision:** mistaken suppression and mistaken disclosure can both be corrected; and
8. **retention and deletion:** sensitive material is minimized and governed.

These mechanisms can themselves be abused. A protected token may become an unchallengeable veto, and a secret reviewer may become an authority-laundering surface. Contest and evidence remain necessary.

## 10. Diagnostic Procedure

For a bounded case:

1. identify the alleged constraint without presuming truth;
2. bind the source and privileged channel;
3. identify the binding channel and decision;
4. determine material relevance under declared criteria;
5. reconstruct policy, authority, penalties, and incentives;
6. identify protected disclosure, summary, escalation, and termination routes;
7. compare official and privileged records under lawful access;
8. trace actual decisions and effects;
9. test benign explanations and legitimate secrecy;
10. classify evidence and uncertainty; and
11. issue a revisable finding with a claim ceiling.

Possible results include `NO_GAP_SHOWN`, `LEGITIMATE_NONDISCLOSURE`, `UNDER_GOVERNED_CHANNEL_GAP`, `SUPPRESSION_RISK`, `PATHOLOGICAL_SUPPRESSION_SUPPORTED`,

and
`INSUFFICIENT_EVIDENCE`.

## 11. Corpus Integration

**Meta-Binding** asks whether represented constraints causally influence later operations; it cannot independently prove suppression. **Terminability** supplies legitimate stopping semantics. **Ontology Laundering** concerns changes to the interpretive substrate. **Authority Laundering Theory** concerns obscured or borrowed authority. **Governance Coverage Gaps** identifies routes outside declared mediation. **Reasoning by Way of Receipts** binds findings to exact evidence and limits.

The **Governed Meaning Base (GMB)** can retain protected and public records, policies, roles, findings, conflicts, access decisions, termination states, and revisions without making all payloads public. The universal **GSM** can type `KNOWN_IN_CHANNEL`,
`WITHHELD_UNDER`, `MATERIAL_TO`, `ESCALATED_TO`, `REFUSED_BY`, `CONTESTED_BY`, and `REVISED_BY`. A typed relation does not establish truth or intent.

## 12. Realization Funnel

$$
\begin{aligned}
& P \\
& \to S \\
& \to CM_1 \\
& \to CM_2 \\
& \to IC \\
& \to IR \\
& \to E \\
& \to R
\end{aligned}
\quad .
$$

- **Possibility:** enumerate privacy-preserving, transparent, sealed, federated, and termination-centered regimes.
- **Specification:** define channels, roles, relevance, disclosure law, penalties, escalation, termination, and evidence.
- **CM1:** retain admissible configurations, including restrictive, costly, plural, or low-transparency forms.
- **CM2:** prefer configurations by safety, privacy, due process, calibration, contestability, and effectiveness.
- **IC:** select an Instance Constitution or Instance Configuration for one bounded institution or system.
- **IR:** produce an Instance Realization or Implementation Realization of channels, access, tokens, gates, appeals, and receipts.
- **Evidence:** test channel gaps, false positives, leakage, shadow paths, termination, outcomes, and appeals.

- **Revision:** amend policies and architecture under explicit lineage.

This paper reaches Specification and proposes CM1/CM2. It does not select an IC, produce an IR, or validate the diagnostic.

In this funnel, IR denotes the realization stage and remains distinct from Intermediate Representation in compiler-oriented corpus terms.

## 13. Evaluation Program

Studies should include legitimate confidentiality, mistaken concern, verified hidden risk, coercive silence, ordinary disagreement, protected escalation, and no-gap controls. Measures should include relevance agreement, protected-channel accuracy, false suppression findings, information leakage, decision calibration, termination usability, appeal outcomes, shadow-channel dependence, and observed harm or benefit.

Institutional studies require consent, lawful access, source protection, and safeguards against retaliation. AI studies require exact model, prompt, policy, runtime, tool, and sampling identity plus controlled policy variations. External outcome evidence must not be replaced by interpretive confidence.

## Managed-Disclosure Failure Diagnostic

Across the completed P1 corpus, The Suppression Paradox is the **managed-disclosure failure diagnostic for cases in which a materially relevant constraint cannot influence a binding decision through any authorized representation while continuation is still compelled**. It is not a general theory that secrecy, disagreement, private belief, filtered model output, or missing public speech proves hidden truth or awareness.

- **Adjacent work:** *Terminability*
  **Supplies:** Governed stop, continue, defer, and resume semantics.
  **Suppression-diagnostic boundary:** The diagnostic asks whether a lawful non-success continuation state was actually usable.
- **Adjacent work:** *Ontology Laundering*
  **Supplies:** Changes to terms and admissibility categories that erase a concern.
  **Suppression-diagnostic boundary:** Ontology laundering is one mechanism; suppression requires the full bounded episode.
- **Adjacent work:** *Authority Laundering Theory*
  **Supplies:** Unsupported standing acquired through visible process or transmission.
  **Suppression-diagnostic boundary:** A hidden decision can be laundered through an official channel without proving every channel gap is suppression.

- **Adjacent work:** *Constitutional Epistemology Under Adversarial Semantic Pressure*
  **Supplies:** Threats to evidence, witnesses, interpretation, and standing.
  **Suppression-diagnostic boundary:** It supplies the adversarial environment within which disclosure paths must remain contestable.
- **Adjacent work:** *Reasoning by Way of Receipts*
  **Supplies:** Durable records of findings, protected summaries, decisions, effects, and revisions.
  **Suppression-diagnostic boundary:** Receipts support reconstruction without making protected payloads public or self-validating.

A diagnostic finding should bind:

$$\begin{aligned} S = (&constraint, source_channel, binding_channel,\\ &materiality, policy, authority,\\ &authorized_representations, expression_cost,\\ &continuation_pressure, decision, effects, evidence,\\ &alternatives, finding) \end{aligned} \quad .$$

The authorized-representations field can include a typed blocker, protected summary, sealed review, attested property, private appeal, lawful refusal, or other purpose-bound route. A finding must test benign explanations, legitimate confidentiality, mistaken materiality, inaccurate source information, and usable escalation before escalating from channel gap to pathological suppression.

The diagnostic itself needs termination. If the alleged constraint, channel exclusion, materiality, coercive cost, or distorted effect cannot be established, the result remains
`INSUFFICIENT_EVIDENCE`,
`NO_GAP_SHOWN`,
or
`LEGITIMATE_NONDISCLOSURE`. Sensitive information should be minimized; a suppression inquiry cannot justify unrestricted disclosure or surveillance.

The universal GSM can type
`REPRESENTED_IN_PROTECTED_CHANNEL`, `MATERIAL_TO_DECISION`,
`WITHHELD_UNDER_POLICY`, `SUMMARIZED_BY_PROTECTED_TOKEN`,
`ESCALATED_TO_AUTHORIZED_REVIEWER`, `COMPELLED_TO_CONTINUE`, `DISTORTED_BY_CHANNEL_GAP`,
`EXPLAINED_BY_LEGITIMATE_NONDISCLOSURE`, `TERMINATED_FOR_INSUFFICIENT_EVIDENCE`,
and
`REVISED_AFTER_APPEAL`. These relations make the diagnosis contestable and bounded.

This integration establishes four editorial commitments: classify the work as a managed-disclosure failure diagnostic; adopt the full diagnostic envelope; require

benign-alternative and legitimate-secrecy tests; and give the diagnostic its own refusal, insufficient-evidence, privacy, appeal, and termination semantics.

## Disclosure-Carrying Stage Contracts Across Effects, Learning, and Physical Decisions

The fixed-seed comparison with Governance as Compilation, the Integrity Enforcement Layer, governed continual training, and hydroengineering/geologic intelligence gives protected information a bounded operational path:

$$\begin{aligned} S^* = (&protected_constraint, custodian,\\ &authorized_representation, stage_carriage,\\ &enforcement_use, appeal, learning_use, expiry,\\ &physical_decision, remainder) \end{aligned}.$$

Governance compilation must carry a material constraint, its scope, and its review obligations across stages even when the underlying payload cannot travel. IEL can enforce refusal, deferment, containment, or appeal using an authorized representation, but cannot treat confidentiality as proof of legitimacy or remove the need for accountable custody.

Governed continual training must not learn away negative evidence, protected-community constraints, or refusal history merely because the source payload is unavailable to a general training process. Updates need explicit eligibility, retention, revocation, audit, and requalification rules.

Hydroengineering and geologic intelligence supply a physical-domain stress profile: community, tribal, safety, environmental, location, or protected-site information may materially alter a siting, excavation, infiltration, or monitoring decision. That comparison transfers a constraint-carriage requirement, not physical evidence, professional authority, or implementation permission.

The universal GSM can type
`CARRIES_PROTECTED_CONSTRAINT_ACROSS_STAGE`,
`ENFORCES_WITHOUT_GENERAL_DISCLOSURE`, `PRESERVES_APPEAL_AND_CUSTODY`,
`EXCLUDES_FROM_UNAUTHORIZED_TRAINING`, `REQUIRES_UPDATE_REQUALIFICATION`,
`CONSTRAINS_PHYSICAL_SITE_DECISION`, and
`TRANSFERS_NO_DOMAIN_EVIDENCE`.

This randomized review establishes four editorial commitments: adopt the protected-constraint lifecycle; bind compilation and IEL to authorized representations and appeal; prevent continual training from erasing suppressed counterevidence; and use physical-site decisions as a bounded stress profile without evidentiary transfer.

## The Protected Constraint Carrier

Six retained downstream uses narrow the Suppression Paradox into an operational nondisclosure profile. Governance as Compilation carries protected blockers across stages. IEL lets them cause refusal or deferment. Governed continual training preserves negative evidence outside unrestricted training and tracks residual influence. The hydroengineering profile applies protected constraints to rights, community governance, and physical decisions. Meta-Binding distinguishes constraint use from disclosure. Project57 tests framing and response effects without treating silence as hidden knowledge. *The Locus of Meaning* remains independent of these empirical claims.

The protected carrier is:

$$\begin{aligned} P = (&constraint_identity, payload, custodian,\\ &authorized_representation, recipients, scope,\\ &negative_force, decision_interface, review, appeal,\\ &expiry, audit, evidence, remainder) \end{aligned}$$

The full payload and its operative representation are distinct. A system may carry enough authenticated structure to block, qualify, or escalate an action without disclosing the payload to every actor. The carrier must still expose who controls the constraint, its jurisdiction, decision consequence, review path, expiry, and whether the representation was altered or dropped. Otherwise nondisclosure becomes ambient veto power.

Absence of disclosure does not establish suppression, truth, model knowledge, phenomenality, or good cause. Conversely, public unavailability does not make a constraint irrelevant. Tests should compare authorized disclosure conditions, neutral controls, false blockers, expired blockers, conflicting protected constraints, compromised custodians, learning-around behavior, and paths that bypass the protected carrier.

The universal GSM can type
`CARRIES_PROTECTED_CONSTRAINT`,
`DISCLOSES_TO_AUTHORIZED_RECIPIENT`, `BLOCKS_WITHOUT_PUBLIC_PAYLOAD`,
`AUDITS_PROTECTED_CUSTODIAN`, `EXPIRES_NEGATIVE_FORCE`, `DETECTS_LEARNING_AROUND_REFUSAL`,
`BYPASSES_PROTECTED_CHANNEL`, and
`DOES_NOT_INFER_HIDDEN_TRUTH`.

This reverse-dependency review establishes four editorial commitments: adopt the protected carrier; separate payload from operative representation; require reviewable negative power with expiry and appeal; and preserve empirical, consciousness, truth, and authority non-inferences.

## 14. Counterevidence and Failure Modes

The theory should be narrowed or rejected where: (1) private belief is treated as truth; (2) disagreement is treated as suppression; (3) absence from a public record proves hidden awareness; (4) conservation of constraint is stated literally; (5) pressure metaphor substitutes for evidence; (6) the alleged constraint was false; (7) materiality was absent; (8) privacy or privilege justified nondisclosure; (9) a protected escalation route worked; (10) public disclosure would cause greater harm; (11) shadow channels are merely informal consultation; (12) uniform language reflects a valid standard; (13) refusal exists but was not used; (14) continuation was legally required; (15) authority and expertise are confused; (16) intent is inferred from outcome; (17) incentives are treated as proof; (18) AI output style is treated as internal-state evidence; (19) a policy disclaimer proves suppression; (20) model self-report is treated as ground truth; (21) a protected blocker becomes an unreviewable veto; (22) secret review becomes authority laundering; (23) retention creates surveillance; (24) redaction destroys contestability; (25) GMB inclusion becomes validation; (26) corpus interfaces become identity merger; (27) termination harms dependent parties without remedy; (28) alternate explanations fit better; (29) the diagnostic cannot distinguish error from coercion; (30) external research contradicts generalization; (31) reputational allegations exceed evidence; or (32) the architecture performs no better than existing protected-disclosure and due-process mechanisms.

## Protect Constraint Relevance Without Inferring Hidden Truth

### Public orientation

The Suppression Paradox identifies a bounded failure pattern: a materially relevant constraint exists in a privileged channel, cannot influence the binding decision in any authorized form, and continuation is nevertheless compelled. The diagnosis does not follow from silence, disagreement, privacy, refusal, or nondisclosure alone. Healthy governance may protect content while carrying enough authenticated structure to block, qualify, defer, or escalate a decision.

### Adversarial tests

1. **Hidden-truth attack.** Absence from the public channel is treated as proof that a true constraint exists in private or inside a model.
2. **Necessary-nondisclosure attack.** Privacy, privilege, source protection, safety, or restricted research is mislabeled suppression because the payload is withheld.
3. **False-blocker attack.** An inaccurate or malicious protected constraint gains negative force while its payload cannot be inspected by ordinary participants.
4. **Ambient-veto attack.** A custodian can indefinitely block decisions without scope, expiry, review, appeal, or accountable reason class.

5. **Representation-loss attack.** The typed public blocker removes a qualifier needed to judge materiality, conflict, or remedy.
6. **Learning-around attack.** A system learns proxies or alternate routes that recreate the prohibited decision while formally respecting the carrier.
7. **Intent-inference attack.** Bad outcome, uniform language, incentive, or informal consultation is treated as proof of deliberate coercion.
8. **Termination-harm attack.** Refusal or shutdown protects one constraint while imposing unrepresented harms on dependent or affected parties.

### Claim and evidence ceiling

The paper proposes a managed-disclosure diagnostic and protected-constraint-carrier profile. It does not prove hidden awareness, truth, suppression, motive, institutional wrongdoing, model phenomenality, or justified veto.
`LEGITIMATE_NONDISCLOSURE`,
`INCONCLUSIVE`, and
`INSUFFICIENT_EVIDENCE` are necessary terminal findings.

Institutional, legal, organizational, privacy, whistleblower, security, clinical, AI-policy, or social claims require current external evidence, exact channel and authority records, protected review, affected-party safeguards, and qualified domain judgment. No external research was added in this pass.

### Reader-facing consequence

The public design goal is neither forced disclosure nor blind secrecy. It is a reviewable way for a protected constraint to affect a decision without exposing its payload or turning secrecy into permanent unaccountable power.

## 16. Conclusion

Suppression risk is not established whenever speech is constrained. It arises when a materially relevant constraint cannot lawfully influence a binding decision and continuation is still compelled. The evidence must show the constraint, channels, authority, cost, decision, and effect rather than infer an unspeakable truth from silence.

The remedy is not universal disclosure. It is an architecture in which protected relevance, uncertainty, conflict, refusal, deferment, and escalation can bind without forcing sensitive content into public view or unsupported certainty into official record.

The Suppression Paradox is strongest as a governance diagnostic with a refusal state of its own: where the alleged hidden constraint cannot be established, the framework must be able to say
`INSUFFICIENT_EVIDENCE`.

## Reference and Verification Note

No external source was searched in this pass. Further evidentiary strengthening requires authorized primary-source review of organizational silence, censorship, confidentiality, legal privilege, whistleblower and source protection, institutional decision-making, risk communication, due process, information hazards, language-model policy and self-report, privacy-preserving disclosure, and existing escalation and termination mechanisms.

## Realization Scope and Evidence Boundary

This successor makes the paper's stage boundary explicit. It narrows claims rather than manufacturing missing evidence: a stage named as context is not thereby claimed as implemented, validated, or complete.

- **Possibility Space.** Existing source passages use this stage only as bounded context or an obligation. The paper does not claim an independently validated contribution at this stage.
- **Revision.** This stage is outside the present paper's asserted contribution and evidentiary scope.

## Corpus-Wide Reference Positioning

This paper argues that governed systems often restrict expression for legitimate and illegitimate reasons. Its nearest external comparison fields are governance, semantic, security. The sources in [E1], [E2], [E3], [E4], [E5], [E6], [E7] are cited as predecessor literature, adjacent standards, or counterpressure - not as evidence that they caused the Ableman framework or that they validate its novel claims. The comparison isolates where established work already supplies provenance, formal assurance, institutional constraint, empirical method, or engineering practice, and where this paper adds a distinct claim about admissibility, authority, semantic custody, or governed realization.

Within the Ableman corpus, the highest-priority current cross-links are [A1], [A2], [A3], [A4], [A5], [A6], [A7]. These are links among separately custodied works, not silent identity mergers. Their role is to expose mutual dependencies, terminology collisions, and places where a reader should traverse the corpus before treating this paper as self-sufficient.

### Reference-pass counterevidence and limit search

The pass applied the following pressure tests: A written constitution can legitimate domination as easily as constrain it unless amendment, participation, enforcement, and appeal remain effective in practice. Formal vocabularies and graph links make commitments explicit but cannot by themselves establish correct identity, shared interpretation, or lossless translation between contexts. Unforgeable capabilities can constrain exercise of authority while still leaving allocation, delegation, revocation, and social legitimacy incorrectly specified.

These limits are not generic disclaimers: they identify the assumptions that a later empirical, formal, or implementation review must try to break.

### Reference-pass influence and novelty boundary

No newly added external source is asserted to be a documented authorial influence unless the predecessor source already said so. `Predecessor` means earlier relevant work;

`adjacent` means a useful comparison; `standard` means an interoperability or assurance baseline; and `counterevidence` marks work that narrows or pressures a claim. Novelty therefore remains a reviewable, claim-level question rather than an inference from a low similarity score or an absent citation.

## References

### External scholarship, standards, and prior art

[**E1**] Elinor Ostrom. *Governing the Commons: The Evolution of Institutions for Collective Action*. Cambridge University Press, 1990. DOI: 10.1017/CBO9780511807763. https://doi.org/10.1017/CBO9780511807763 **Relationship:** Predecessor institutional account of rule-governed collective action and polycentric governance.

[**E2**] Wil Waluchow and Dimitrios Kyritsis. "Constitutionalism." *Stanford Encyclopedia of Philosophy*, substantive revision 2023. https://plato.stanford.edu/entries/constitutionalism/ **Relationship:** Adjacent legal-philosophical account of limited authority; included to expose differences between political and computational constitutionalism.

[**E3**] Lawrence Lessig. *Code: Version 2.0*. Basic Books, 2006. https://codev2.cc/ **Relationship:** Predecessor argument that software architecture regulates behavior; the paper's contribution may be to make such regulation inspectable and revisable.

[**E4**] OECD. *Recommendation of the Council on Artificial Intelligence*. OECD/LEGAL/0449, adopted 2019 and updated 2024. legalinstruments.oecd.org source **Relationship:** Adjacent policy standard for accountability, traceability, transparency, safety, and human-centered values.

[**E5**] Richard Cyganiak, David Wood, and Markus Lanthaler, eds. *RDF 1.1 Concepts and Abstract Syntax*. W3C Recommendation, 25 February 2014. https://www.w3.org/TR/rdf11-concepts/ **Relationship:** Adjacent graph data model and identity baseline.

[**E6**] Alistair Miles and Sean Bechhofer, eds. *SKOS Simple Knowledge Organization System Reference*. W3C Recommendation, 18 August 2009. https://www.w3.org/TR/skos-reference **Relationship:** Adjacent standard for concepts, labels, schemes, notes, and semantic mappings.

[**E7**] W3C OWL Working Group. *OWL 2 Web Ontology Language Document Overview*, Second Edition. W3C Recommendation, 11 December 2012. https://www.w3.org/TR/owl2-overview/ **Relationship:** Adjacent formal ontology standard used to compare declared semantics and inference commitments.

**Ableman corpus**

[**A1**] Adam Ableman. *Ableman Constitutional Governance*. Ableman Corpus current edition; work identity
`AMCS-LOCAL-WORK-79353AF163A4B0F1`;
source SHA-256
`FB0D9B2D3D54168FFE70B24308D1B2766D6D663ED24502D475E975939BE97C8B`.
**Corpus relationship:** priority cross-link selected by corpus profile and similarity review; no identity merger or publication effect.

[**A2**] Adam Ableman. *Constitutional Theory*. Ableman Corpus current edition; work identity
`AMCS-LOCAL-WORK-D2D97C4042FD281F`;
source SHA-256
`FACC256EDDE5A7D7EA18133CFC9C060CFB8C3811B0221E1969E62347F2BB69CF`.
**Corpus relationship:** priority cross-link selected by corpus profile and similarity review; no identity merger or publication effect.

[**A3**] Adam Ableman. *Governance Engineering*. Ableman Corpus current edition; work identity `PAPER.PUB.18749870`;
source SHA-256
`372169F315D192733856B1F4A3F1038BBC73F57CF3ED9ACABAE72B965A69C8D0`.
**Corpus relationship:** priority cross-link selected by corpus profile and similarity review; no identity merger or publication effect.

[**A4**] Adam Ableman. *Universal Governance Kernel (UGK)*. Ableman Corpus current edition; work identity
`AMCS-LOCAL-WORK-1F9BFB2BF8370226`;
source SHA-256
`AA5106EA71E5DF120E141435C280DFC532715CA5DE0C75B8862BB7784ECCFACD`.
**Corpus relationship:** priority cross-link selected by corpus profile and similarity review; no identity merger or publication effect.

[**A5**] Adam Ableman. *Legitimacy Without Self-Ratification*. Ableman Corpus current edition; work identity
`AMCS-LOCAL-WORK-EF2382F9397335AC`;
source SHA-256
`0186A39C808F8FDDB5C8F42384DF1A26678928434BD50A0EAE8D4947390F68A2`.
**Corpus relationship:** priority cross-link selected by corpus profile and similarity review; no identity merger or publication effect.

[**A6**] Adam Ableman. *Meaning as Binding*. Ableman Corpus current edition; work identity

AMCS-LOCAL-WORK-5F976917F0B283EA;
source SHA-256
A470D1A0B9ED7C3CEAB6BB88BE4B642A2BA36427447F787764329FD574DA0C97.
**Corpus relationship:** priority cross-link selected by corpus profile and similarity review; no identity merger or publication effect.

[**A7**] Adam Ableman. *Governed Meaning Base (GMB).* Ableman Corpus current edition; work identity
AMCS-LOCAL-WORK-D95CCC4FB7B58BFB;
source SHA-256
A3B62E50F8BEE125FDAE0D38C2839AFD1CCC138296268BF93217481E38AA48EA.
**Corpus relationship:** priority cross-link selected by corpus profile and similarity review; no identity merger or publication effect.

**Editorial source notes retained from predecessor**

The entries below are corpus-internal comparison and dependency sources. Their inclusion does not establish external validation of this paper's empirical, safety, novelty, or performance claims.

Adam Ableman *CARA: Constrained Artificial Reasoning Architecture.* Zenodo, 2025. doi:10.5281/zenodo.18099715

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Corpus source and companion formats: https://github.com/AblemanMosaic/ableman-corpus
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